

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM (Merit) graduate with practical experience in legal research, document and case management, client-facing advisory work and regulatory analysis. Dissertation on cross-jurisdictional GDPR development awarded Distinction (75%). Practical exposure to finance and private equity through A&O Shearman's open day, a Coursera PE course and the Clifford Chance Real Estate Finance programme. Experience supporting complex commercial matters at BCLP, including an international investment arbitration, with responsibility for deadline tracking, file management, client liaison and procedural document drafting. Developing interest in financial markets law and the knowledge and research infrastructure that supports leading finance teams.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Dissertation: cross-jurisdictional development of GDPR — awarded Distinction (75%); required structured legal research across multiple regulatory frameworks and jurisdictions
- Modules included international arbitration, procedural law, evidence analysis and legal research methods

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law, Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended sections of the memorial and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the only junior on the matter shortly before a significant procedural deadline: coordinated outstanding documents, tracked actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines across the matter
- Liaised directly with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes; prepared research notes for fee earners
- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines; maintained matter records via iManage

- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Interviews clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Researches complex statutory and regulatory points; assesses eligibility against criteria and identifies evidential gaps
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with Adobe's internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and advice writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural document drafting, structured case-file organisation, deadline tracking across competing matters